



## Dawn Of The Drones In India

Unmanned aerial vehicles, popularly known as drones, vary in size depending on their application. These are now finding use in numerous sectors including logistics, disaster management, agricultural services, defence, and even event and wedding planning. So, there is no doubt that their demand is likely to increase exponentially in the coming years. Read on for details

EFY Bureau

**T**he drone industry is placed among the top priority in Prime Minister Modi's Vision 2024. The current market of Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV), also popularly known as Drone, is at nascent stage in India and is witnessing the emergence of a whole new ecosystem, value delivery model, and off course a new breed of entrepreneurs and start-ups. Though UAV market in India is at its entry stage, it has already drawn attention of the policy makers, tech start ups, and potential enterprise customers. The stakeholders are expected to join hands and create a sustainable UAV ecosystem.



Fig. 1: Drone is a layman terminology for unmanned aircraft (UA). There are three subsets of unmanned aircraft: (a) remotely piloted aircraft, (b) autonomous aircraft, and (c) model aircraft (Source: DigitalSky)

The need of UAVs in the modern world is rooted to the paradigm shift in the modern world which is more data centric and exploring new possibilities of logistical evolution. Data acquisition has become the key for any strategic decision, mainly the visual data for planning, monitoring, and controlling. The enterprises are increasingly facing the challenges in bringing efficiency in the operations that are logistical in nature while keeping the risk exposure level low for the humans.

The technology proliferation is gaining momentum with continuously evolving use cases across a number of industries and applications. The stakeholders—including the OEMs, service providers, investors, government and policy makers, end-consumers, startup community, and enterprises are showing keen interest to participate across the value chain.

### Innovative use cases to accelerate the pace of adoption of UAV technology

Indian market is already witnessing applications of nano and micro UAVs in the use cases requiring the UAV to fly within the visual line-of-sight. Availability of medium and large drones in India at a cheaper price will create new opportunities across a number of applications that require scalability and flexibility in payloads. While e-commerce, media & entertainment, disaster management and transportation seem to be the early adopters in the consumer UAV segment, other core industries such as healthcare, infrastructure, energy & utilities, mining, agriculture, etc will follow the suit, depending upon the